

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Duck Mac and Cheese

with Gruyère and Thyme

Impress your dinner date with this fun food fact: The pasta shape in our Frenched-up version of mac 'n' cheese is known as *gemelli* (like "je-MEHL-lee"), the Italian word for twins, because it looks like twin strands of spaghetti twisted together. Is there a Gemini at the table? Gemelli is also your Italian *segni Zodiacali*. In any case, we see plenty of duck, thyme, and creamy Gruyère sauce in your future...

30–40 minutes 850 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- 12 ounces ground duck
- ⅛ ounce thyme
- 1 shallot
- 6 ounces gemelli
- 1 packet unsalted butter
- 2 tablespoons flour
- 8 ounces milk
- 2 ounces shredded Gruyère cheese
- 3 tablespoons panko breadcrumbs
- 1 ounce baby arugula
- 1 aluminum tin

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
8" medium pot
10" medium high-sided pan
baking sheet

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

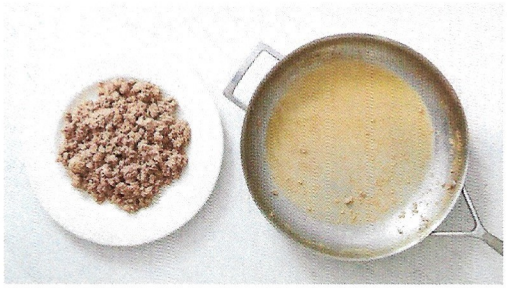
Here's a cheffy trick for picking thyme leaves all at once: Pinch the stem near the top with 1 hand, then slide the fingers of your other hand down the length of the stem, from top to bottom. The leaves will come off easily.

Don't be afraid to use most of the pasta cooking water in Step 5—you want the gemelli to stay saucy and creamy all the way through baking. It'll continue to set and thicken!

USDA recommends cooking ground duck to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Brown duck

Preheat oven to 475°F. Bring a medium pot of water to a boil over high heat. Pat **duck** dry with paper towel. Heat **½ tablespoon olive oil** in a medium high-sided pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **duck** and season with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired. Cook, breaking up, until browned, about 5 minutes. Using a slotted spoon, transfer **duck** to a plate; reserve fat in pan, off heat, for Step 4.



2. Prepare ingredients

While duck cooks, rinse all produce. Strip **thyme** leaves, discarding stems (see recipe tip). Peel **shallot**, halve, and thinly slice. Reshape **aluminum tin** if bent, then place on a baking sheet for Step 5—this will help stabilize the pasta for easy transfer to the oven and even cooking.



3. Cook gemelli

Season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **gemelli** and cook until al dente, about 7 minutes. Reserve **¼ cup pasta cooking water** (it's easiest to reserve this water in a liquid measuring cup, if you have one). Then, drain **gemelli** and set aside.



4. Make cheese sauce

Return pan with duck fat to medium-high heat and add **butter**. When butter is foamy, add **shallot** and sauté, stirring, until softened, 2–3 minutes. Reduce heat to medium and add **flour**; cook, stirring, until flour is lightly browned, 1 minute. Whisking continuously, add **milk** and cook until thickened, 2–3 minutes more. Remove pan from heat. Whisk in **thyme**, **half of Gruyère**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** to combine.



5. Bake mac and cheese

Return browned **duck** to pan with sauce, still off heat. Add cooked **gemelli**. Toss to coat. Adding 2 tablespoons at a time, stir in **reserved pasta cooking water** until sauce is silky and clings to noodles (see recipe tip). Transfer **pasta and sauce** to **tin**; spread in an even layer. Sprinkle over **remaining Gruyère**, then **breadcrumbs**. Transfer sheet to oven; bake until cheese is melted and breadcrumbs are golden brown, 14–16 minutes.



6. Plate duck mac and cheese

Take a mini break to set the table or pour yourself a well-deserved drink. After 10 minutes of pasta baking, pat **arugula** dry with paper towel and place in a small bowl; toss with **1 teaspoon olive oil**, **⅛ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired. Divide **duck mac and cheese** between serving plates, and pile **arugula** on top. Enjoy!

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